

vision**2**learn

Understanding Autism

Hints
and
Tips

Unit 1



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Hints and Tips Unit 1

The information in this guide will be helpful to you when you are ready to complete your assessment for the following unit:

Unit 1 - Introduction to autism

Session 1 – Understand what is meant by ‘autism’

- Q1.** In the table below, Describe the following social and communication disorders:
- autistic spectrum condition
 - Asperger syndrome
 - high-functioning autism (HFA) [1.1]

For this question you should use the information on session 1 page 3 for guidance and you may also carry out your own research. As this is a describe question please ensure that you provide good detail in your answer for each of the disorders.

- Q2.** In the box below, **explain** how autism can be considered as a spectrum condition. [1.2]

This is an explain question so try to be as detailed as possible in your response. As well as the course materials there is some information on the following website that you may find useful.

<https://autismsd.com/why-is-autism-considered-a-spectrum-disorder/>

- Q3.** In the box below, **explain** why it is important to recognise that autism is a lifelong condition. [1.3]

This is another explain question so your answer should have good detail. Think about what recognising that autism is a lifelong condition will allow you to do. How does this inform your thinking when planning for the future?

Session 2 – Know theories that relate to autism

Q1. In the table below, **outline** the following theoretical models in relation to identifying autism: [2.1]

This is quite a straightforward question and you simply need to give an outline for the three theoretical models listed. Information relating to this can be found in session 2 page 1.

Q2. In the box below, **explain** how the terms 'neurodiverse' and 'neurotypical' are used in relation to autism. [2.2]

For this question you need to explain so try and be as detailed in your response. Think about what both of these terms are and then how do people use these terms in relation to autism.

Session 3 – Know how autism is diagnosed

Q1. In the box below, **outline** the current guidelines for the diagnosis of autism in the UK. [3.1]

Using the information on session 3 page 1 you simply need to outline the guidelines. You may find it useful to carry out additional research for this as guidelines are constantly changing.

Q2. In the table below, **describe** the difficulties surrounding the diagnosis of autism in relation to. [3.2]

- Formal diagnosis
- The range of different diagnoses on the spectrum

This question is asking for a description so try to provide good detail in your answer. Think about the problems that can be encountered when trying to obtain a formal diagnosis and also the different types of diagnosis. You may also find it useful to carry out research or you may have personal experience that will help when formulating your answer.

Q3. In the box below, give reasons why people may be reluctant to seek a diagnosis. **Please give at least 3 reasons** [3.3]

Why might people be reluctant to seek diagnosis? You might want to think about perception, labels, discrimination when formulating your answer.

Q4. In the box below, **explain** why it is important for individuals to have a formal diagnosis. [3.4]

This question is asking for an explanation so try to provide good detail in your answer. Think about what having a formal diagnosis will achieve. How will this be of benefit to the individual?

Q5. In the box below, **state the prevalence** of autism in the UK. [3.5]

This question is focused on statistics. This is covered in session 3 page 2 but you may find it useful to carry out your own research to help you formulate your answer. Your answer should reflect current figures and include how these are broken down in terms of gender and age.

Session 4 – Understand the characteristics that may be present in individuals with autism

Q1. In the box below, **describe** the main characteristics found in individuals with autism. [4.1]

For this question you should use the information on page 1 of session 4 and then provide a description for each. The main characteristics are features that are common in people with autism, are used to help to recognise the condition, and are used in diagnosis. There's a range of characteristics but not all people with autism will have all characteristics.

Q2. In the box below, **describe** how these characteristics can vary from individual to individual. [4.2]

Using your learning from page 1 of session 4 think about how these different characteristics can be display differently from person to person.

Q3. In the box below, **outline** what is meant by the 'triad of impairments'. [4.3]

For this question you simply need to give an outline of what the "triad of impairments" means. Make sure that you give the answer in your own words or if you do include information from an external source, perhaps a definition from a website, that this is referenced and only used to support your answer it cannot be your only answer. There is also increasing reference to the 'dyad of impairments', in which social interaction and communication are merged under social communication which you may want to consider when formulating your answer.

Q4. In the table below, **identify** positive and negative points of the triad of impairments. [4.4]

This is an identify question so you can just list or bullet points your responses.

Session 5 – Know about conditions that commonly co-occur with autism

- Q1.** In the box below, **explain** the following conditions that may co-occur with autism:
- mental ill-health
 - learning disability. [5.1]

This is an explain question so try to provide good detail in your response. Make sure that you cover both points and consider how these conditions may also be present in people with Autism.

- Q2.** In the box below, **describe** other conditions that may co-occur with autism. [5.2]

As well as mental ill-health and learning disabilities what other conditions are there that may be present in people with Autism? Use the course materials on page 1 of session 5 to help you with this but you may also want to further research on this to help you formulate your response. The following website has some information that you may find useful.

[Common co-conditions associated with autism | The Spectrum](#)

- Q3.** In the box below, **describe** the concerns that can arise from these co-occurring conditions. [5.3]

For this question you need to consider how these other conditions are linked and the affect that they can have on the individual.

Session 6 – Understand common misconceptions surrounding autism

Q1. In the box below, **describe** how attitudes and lack of understanding can compound the difficulties of individuals with autism [6.1]

As well as using the course materials when formulating your response to this question there is a good article which can be accessed using the link below which you may find helpful.

<https://planetradio.co.uk/westsound/local/news/lack-understanding-leaving-many-autistic-people-socially-isolated-4/>

Q2. In the table below, give **examples** of how autism can be misrepresented in the media. Please give 3 examples. [6.2]

When formulating your answer for this question consider the importance of recognising that autism is not a mental health condition, and that individuals may not have a learning disability. As autism is an 'invisible' disability, judgements are often made about behaviour.

Q3. In the box below, **describe** how discrimination against individuals with autism can occur inadvertently in society. [6.3]

For this question, as well as using the content in session 6 page 1 of the course materials, you may find it useful to carry out additional research on how discrimination occurs inadvertently as there are some interesting examples online of how this happens.